



NSW Education Standards Authority

2018 HIGHER SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION

Drama

**General
Instructions**

- Reading time – 5 minutes
- Working time – $1\frac{1}{2}$ hours
- Write using black pen

**Total marks:
40**

Section I – 20 marks (page 2)

- Attempt Question 1
- Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Section II – 20 marks (pages 3–6)

- Attempt ONE question from Questions 2–8
- Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Section I — Australian Drama and Theatre (Core Study)

20 marks

Attempt Question 1

Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Answer the question on pages 2–8 of the Drama Writing Booklet. Extra writing booklets are available.

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate knowledge and understanding of drama and theatre relevant to the question
 - express your point of view using appropriate supporting evidence
 - present a sustained, logical and cohesive response
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Question 1 (20 marks)

How do Australian theatre practitioners create images of a specific time and place to influence an audience's response to cultural issues and concerns?

In your answer, refer to your study and experience of at least TWO plays in this topic.

Topic 1: Dramatic Traditions in Australia

Texts set for study:

- Alex Buzo, *Norm and Ahmed*
- Jack Davis, *No Sugar*
- Dorothy Hewett, *The Chapel Perilous*
- David Williamson, *The Removalists*

OR

Topic 2: Contemporary Australian Theatre Practice

Texts set for study:

- Jane Harrison, *Stolen*
- Lally Katz, *Neighbourhood Watch*
- Daniel Keene, *Life Without Me*
- Mirra Todd, *Fearless*

Section II — Studies in Drama and Theatre

20 marks

Attempt ONE question from Questions 2–8

Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Answer the question on pages 10–16 of the Drama Writing Booklet. Extra writing booklets are available.

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate knowledge and understanding of drama and theatre relevant to the question
 - express your point of view using appropriate supporting evidence
 - present a sustained, logical and cohesive response
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Question 2 — Tragedy (20 marks)

In the staging of tragedies, the contemporary audience is made to focus on the controlling nature of society, rather than the individual's hubris.

Discuss this statement with reference to your study and experience of TWO plays in this topic.

Texts set for study:

List 1

- Sophocles, *Oedipus Tyrannus*

or

- Sophocles, *Antigone*

AND

List 2

- Arthur Miller, *Death of a Salesman*

or

- Tony Kushner, *Angels in America (Part 1)*

OR

Question 3 — Approaches to Acting (20 marks)

Actor training in the 20th century was more about practitioners' philosophies than engaging an audience in the aesthetics of performance.

To what extent is this true of contemporary theatre practice?

In your answer, refer to your study and experience of TWO practitioners in this topic.

Practitioners and texts set for study:

- Augusto Boal, *Games for Actors and Non Actors*
- Jacques Lecoq, *The Moving Body*
- Jonathan Pitches, *Vsevolod Meyerhold*
- James Slowiak and Jairo Cuesta, *Jerzy Grotowski*

OR

Question 4 — Verbatim Theatre (20 marks)

For an audience to engage with the tension of Verbatim Theatre, theatricality is more important than truth.

Discuss this statement with reference to TWO texts set for study and your experience of the topic.

Texts set for study:

- Robin Soans, *Talking to Terrorists*
- Campion Decent, *Embers*
- Tom Holloway, *Beyond the Neck*
- Alana Valentine, *Parramatta Girls*

OR

Question 5 — Black Comedy (20 marks)

We laugh, because if we thought about it, we'd cry.

Discuss this statement with reference to the staging of the controversial in Black Comedy.

In your answer, refer to your study and experience of TWO plays in this topic.

Texts set for study:

- Martin McDonagh, *The Lieutenant of Inishmore*
- Harold Pinter, *The Homecoming*
- Ian Wilding, *October*
- Neil La Bute, *The Shape of Things*

OR

Question 6 — Multi-Discipline Theatre (20 marks)

How do practitioners of Multi-Discipline Theatre imaginatively challenge traditional representation to present individual and community experiences?

In your answer, refer to your study and experience of this topic.

Practitioners and texts set for study:

- Robert Lepage and ExMachina

Texts set for study:

- Sasa Aleksandar Dundjerovic, *Robert Lepage*
- Patrick Caux and Bernard Gilbert, *ExMachina: Creating for the Stage*

or

- Simon McBurney and Theatre de Complicite

Texts set for study:

- Complicite, *A Disappearing Number*
- Complicite, *Complicite Rehearsal Notes, a visual essay of the unique working methods of the company*

OR

Question 7 — Significant Plays of the 20th Century (20 marks)

A play can be revolutionary or break new ground through content and staging, but may have no lasting impact beyond the original production.

Discuss this statement with reference to your study and experience of TWO plays in this topic.

Texts set for study:

- Anton Chekhov, *The Cherry Orchard*
- Bertholt Brecht, *Mother Courage*
- Eugene Ionesco, *The Bald Prima Donna* (also known as *The Bald Soprano*)
- Caryl Churchill, *Top Girls*
- Moisés Kaufman and Members of the Tectonic Theatre Project, *The Laramie Project*

OR

Question 8 — Japanese Traditional and Contemporary Theatre (20 marks)

‘There is probably no such thing as a universal theatre but there is a possibility for theatre artists to address universal problems.’

TADASHI SUZUKI

Eelka Lampe, ‘Collaboration and Cultural Clashing: Anne Bogart and Tadashi Suzuki’s Saratoga International Theatre Institute’, *The Drama Review*, 37:1 (T137 – Spring, 1993), pp147–156. © 1993 by New York University and the Massachusetts Institute of Technology, published by the MIT Press. <https://www.mitpressjournals.org/loi/dram>

To what extent is this statement represented in the performance styles and staging of Japanese Traditional and Contemporary Theatre?

In your answer, refer to your study and experience of this topic.

Texts set for study:

ONE of the following traditional Japanese forms:

- James Brandon, *Kabuki: Five Classic Plays*
- Ernest Fenollosa and Ezra Pound, *The Noh Theatre of Japan: With Complete Texts of 15 Classic Plays*
- Stanleigh H Jones, (trans.), ‘The Mountains’ from *Mount Imo and Mount Se: Precepts for Women*

AND

- Tadashi Suzuki, *The Way of Acting*

or

- Paul Allain, *The Art of Stillness, The Theatre Practice of Tadashi Suzuki*

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